UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
General Certificate of Education Ordinary Level

ENGLISH LANGUAGE **1123/21**

Paper 2 Reading **October/November 2013**

INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This insert contains the two reading passages.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.

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Passage 1

Reading and Viewing

1 Reading has been around for a long time; by comparison, the cinema is a relatively recent invention. Sometimes, books – both fiction and non-fiction – are made into films. If the books are particularly famous ones, these films are released in a blaze of publicity. Perhaps less frequently, a film is so popular that a book of the film is written from the screenplay.

2 Films of novels help us to imagine characters; for example, anyone who has seen one of the 'Harry Potter' films has a fixed idea now of what the hero and his friends and teachers look like. Settings of books also come to life in films, whether it is castles, or cities, or lush countryside. Cinematic special effects in adventure or science fiction films – where we seem actually to be seeing car chases, sea battles or spacecraft landing – can be more realistic than even the wildest of imaginations. Films of non-fiction texts can be as informative as the books but they are often more interesting than the books, perhaps bringing to life the achievements of famous doctors or statesmen in a way their biographies fail to do.

3 In schools, seeing a film version of a literary text, for example a Shakespeare play or a Charles Dickens novel, can help students appreciate the text they are studying. An interest in a particular genre, such as science fiction or adventure, might be stimulated, further increasing reading and, consequently, language skills. Teachers can help less motivated students by showing the film first, so that knowing the story before being given the book will make the task of reading it easier than it would otherwise have been.

4 If the language of a book is difficult, the film version can make the language more accessible, and if an international best seller is made into a film, subtitles may be added to the film so that it can be understood by people who speak a different first language. The experience of viewing the film of a novel in a full cinema is a communal experience, very different from the solitary activity of reading the novel. Many people follow up the film experience by buying the book, and thus it can be seen that films increase overall reading. Reading can be seen as being 'cool' by young people who read the book, see the film and buy the merchandise that accompanies it.

5 On the other hand, it could be argued that, far from stimulating the imagination, watching films of books actually curbs the imagination. Furthermore, watching films of books often makes people too lazy to read them. How will language skills be improved in schools, complain some teachers, if students take the short cut to the film and bypass the book? The benefits of reading – enhanced vocabulary, better spelling, finding ideas for writing texts of their own – are all lost. This may be a very extreme view but one that is heard in staffrooms in many parts of the world.

6 Opportunities for watching films of books are restricted to when they are available in cinemas, and the season for each film might be no more than a couple of weeks. Compare this to curling up with a good book any time you like! There are also place restrictions when it comes to watching films, as this can happen only in a cinema or, in the case of DVDs, in certain rooms in your own home. On the other hand, books can be enjoyed anywhere – on the bus, in a park, in a café. Films can be purchased in DVD form but that is often more expensive than buying the novel. A book can be re-visited again and again and become almost like an old friend; although a DVD can be watched more than once, its owner is less likely to become attached to it in the same way as one can become attached to a favourite book. Some novels have layers of meaning or perhaps an element of ambiguity; for example, the ending might be implied rather than stated, and the charm of the novel lies in the reader's personal interpretation. It is almost impossible to capture such ambiguity in a film; the viewer is presented with the director's point of view as being the final judgement.

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Passage 2

Miss Garnet and Harriet Josephs were teachers who shared an apartment for more than 30 years until Harriet's death.

1 When Miss Garnet's friend Harriet died, Miss Garnet decided to spend six months abroad.

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'I believe it is cheaper at this time of year.'

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